

Board Study

Review of Enrollment Committee Report



MORONGO
UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

Attendance / 10th Day Count

- As of August 21, Morongo Unified had **7,109** students in attendance, with **7,152** currently enrolled students.
- Including pending enrollments, total enrollment stands at **7,211** students.
- Enrollment for the 2025–26 school year was **7,305** students, representing a **94-student decrease** from last year.

Site	Attendance	Site	Attendance
CES	327	LCMS	649
FHES	282	TPJHS	601
JTES	259	TPHS	680
LES	104	YVHS	1,051
MVES	181	BRHS	115
OES	384	ACCE E	66
ONES	556	ACCE W	161
PVES	308	PLUS	29
TPES	477	TOTAL	7,109
YMES	351		
YVES	528		

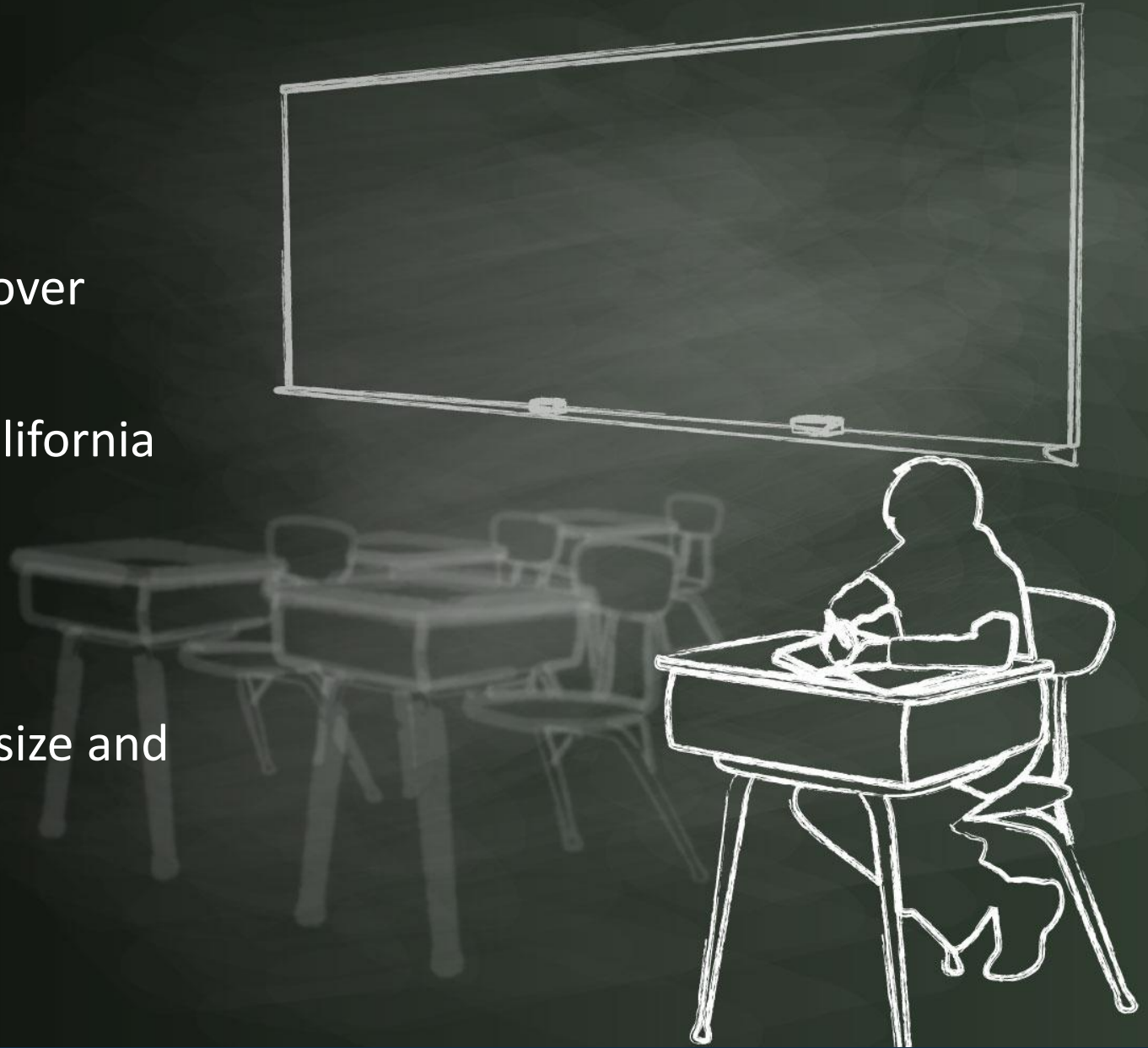
Combo Classes

- The number of combination classes across the District's elementary schools has decreased from 25 in 2025–26 to 18 currently.

Site	Combo Classes 25/26	Combo Classes 26/27
CES	1	2
FHES	3	3
JTES	3	2
LES	5	3
MVES	2	2
OES	2	1
ONES	2	0
PVES	2	1
TPES	1	0
YMES	2	1
YVES	2	3
Total	25	18

ENROLLMENT REALITY

- Steady decline in enrollment over several decades
- Reflects broader statewide California trend
- Fewer school-aged children in families
- Demographic shifts changing size and distribution of students



STATEWIDE CONTEXT

- Declining enrollment impacting districts statewide
- Financial realities require proactive planning
- We must act responsibly and strategically

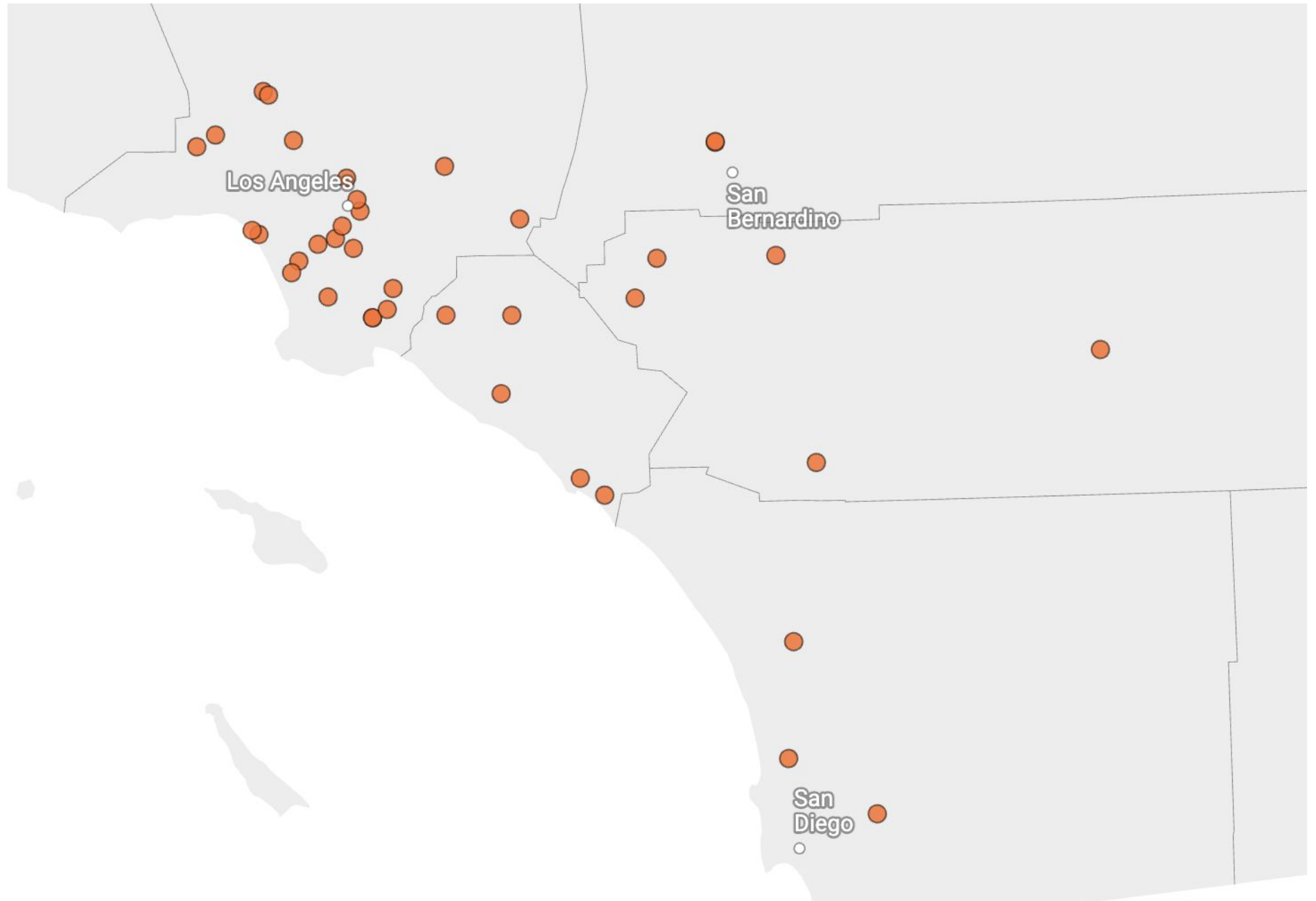


57

California public schools closed in 2024-25 — double the amount in 2022-23



73 public schools closed in California in 2026 through July



HISTORICAL PERSPECTIVE FOR MUSD

1986	→	7,40	→	7
2006	→	9,70	→	11
2026	→	9,30	→	11

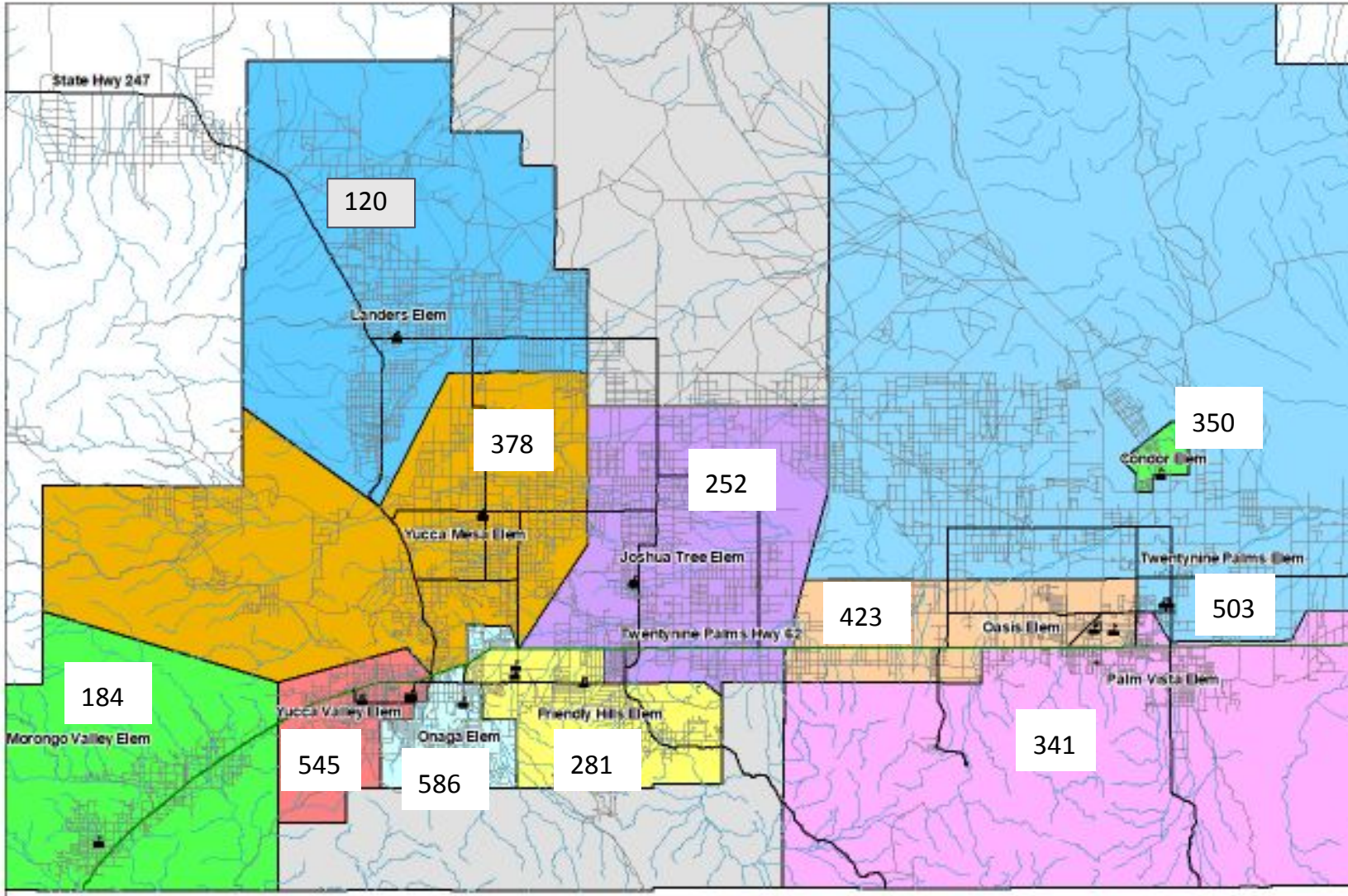
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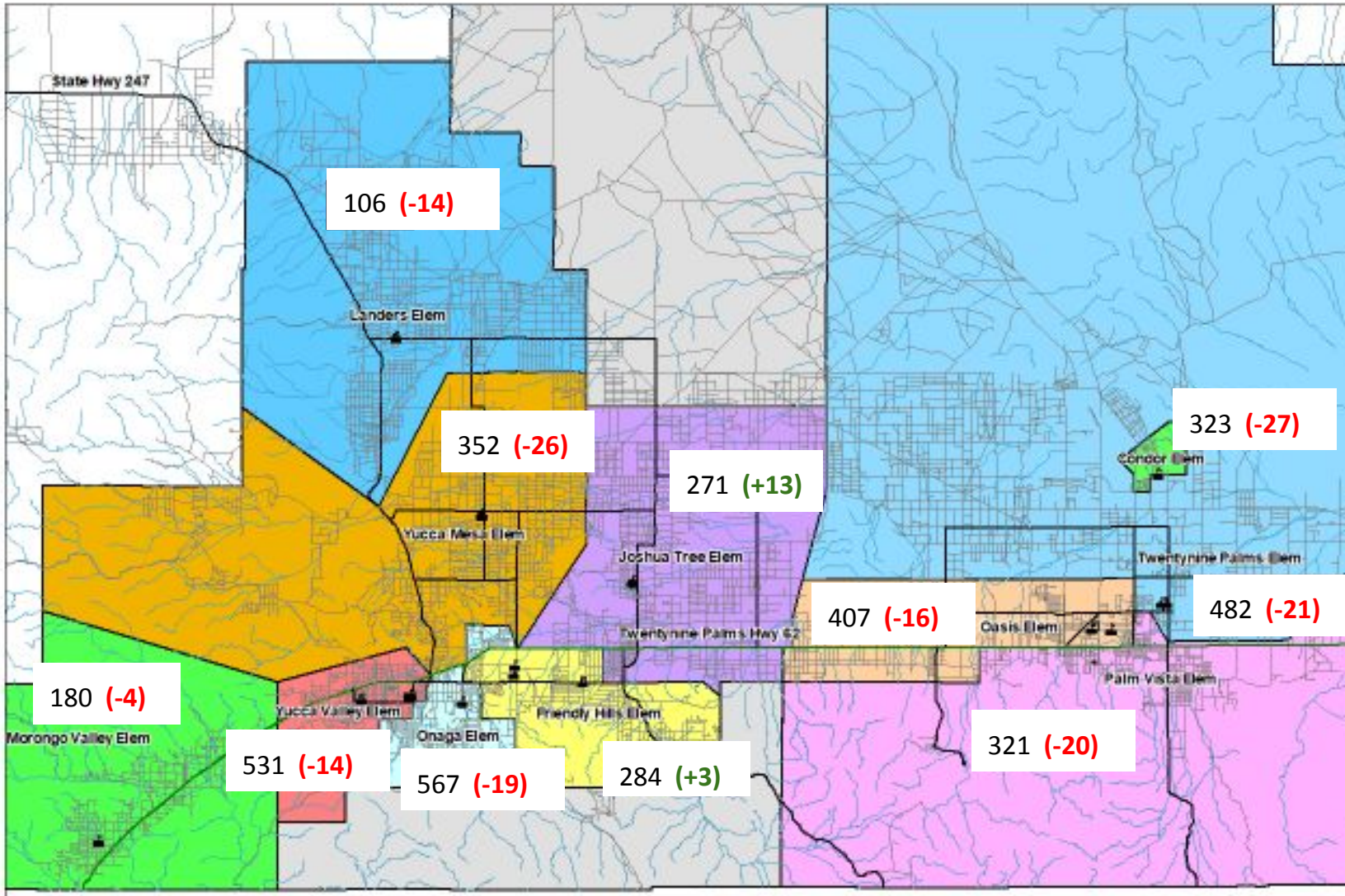
Boundary Scenarios



25/26 School Boundaries
with Enrollment



Current School Boundaries
with Current Enrollment
Updated for 26/27



Boundary Scenario 1 Summary

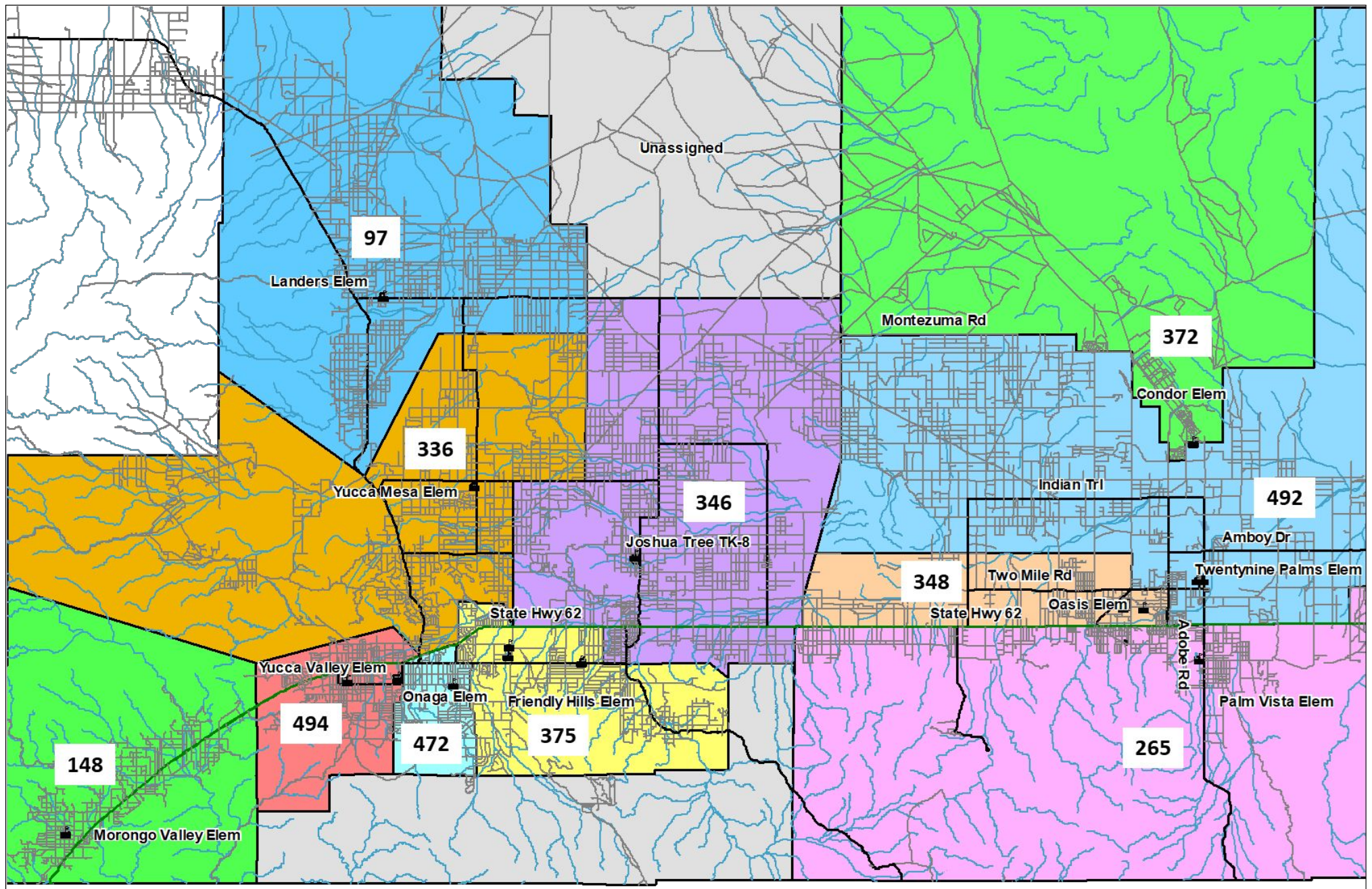
- No closures
- Joshua Tree expands to grades TK-8
- West side schools boundaries adjusted for improved balancing
- East side schools boundaries adjusted for improved balancing

Projections assume current transfer patterns

All scenarios use 2027-28 Projections



Scenario 1 Boundary Map with 2027 Projections



Scenario 1 Enrollment Projections

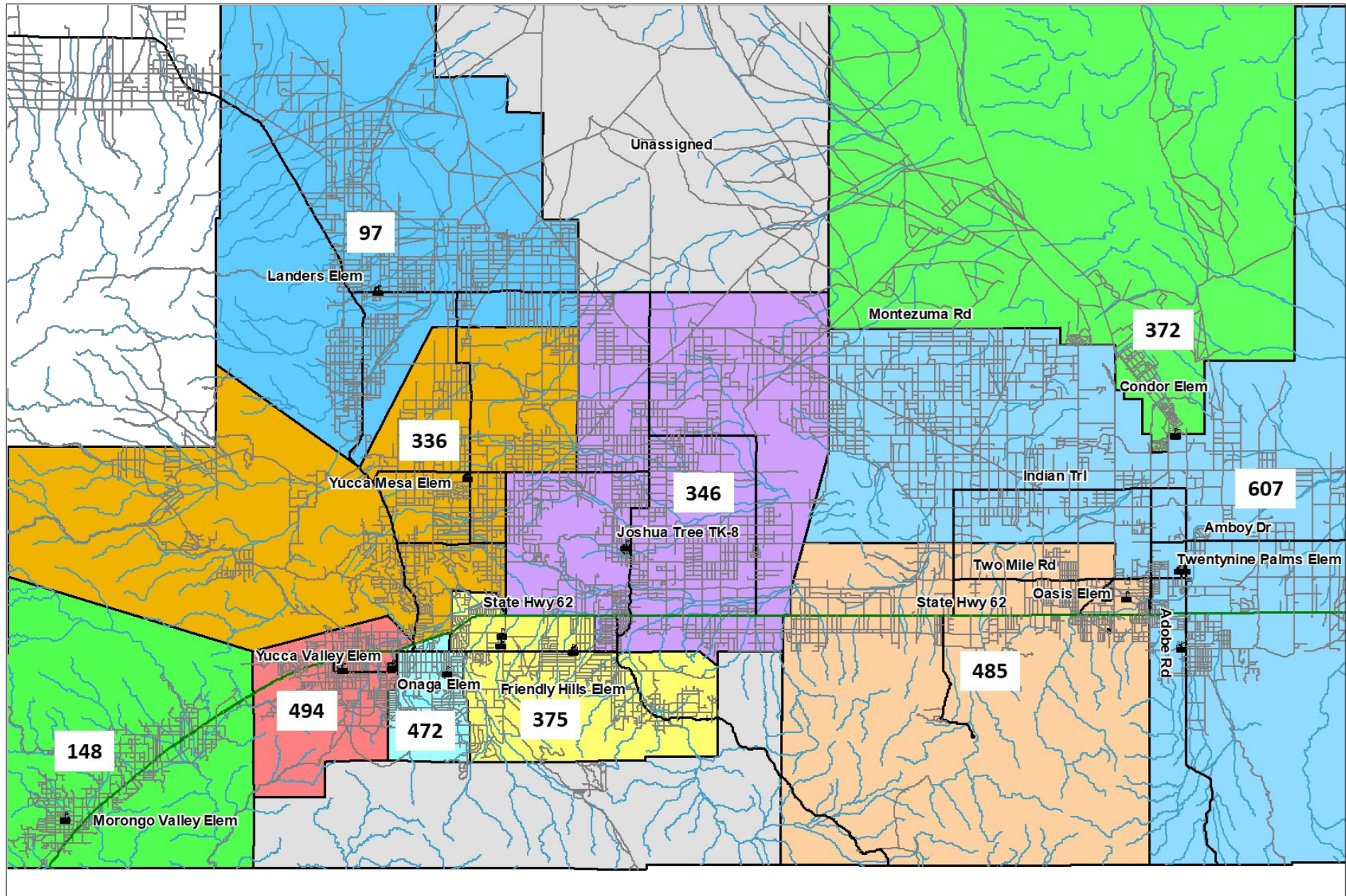
	Net	Net CR	2025/26	2027/28	2031/32
	Classrooms	Capacity	Current Enrollment	Projected Enrollment	Projected Enrollment
<u>Elementary Schools</u>					
Condor Elem	30	743	350	372	311
Friendly Hills Elem	23	592	281	375	332
Joshua Tree Elem	20	548	252	346	306
Landers Elem	12	316	120	97	77
Morongo Valley Elem	15	406	184	148	109
Oasis Elem	29	733	423	348	310
Onaga Elem	30	784	586	472	415
Palm Vista Elem	26	658	341	265	233
Twentynine Palms Elem	33	847	503	492	448
Yucca Mesa Elem	27	706	378	336	298
Yucca Valley Elem	34	878	545	494	454
Sub-Totals	279	7,211	3,963	3,745	3,293
<u>Middle/Junior High Schools</u>					
La Contenta Middle	39	1,287	653	591	542
Twentynine Palms Junior High	21	669	648	691	599
Sub-Totals	60	1,956	1,301	1,282	1,141

Boundary Scenario 2 Summary

- Palm Vista closed and boundary area assigned to Oasis/29 Palms
- Joshua Tree expands to grades TK-8
- West side schools boundaries adjusted for improved balancing
- East side schools boundaries adjusted for improved balancing



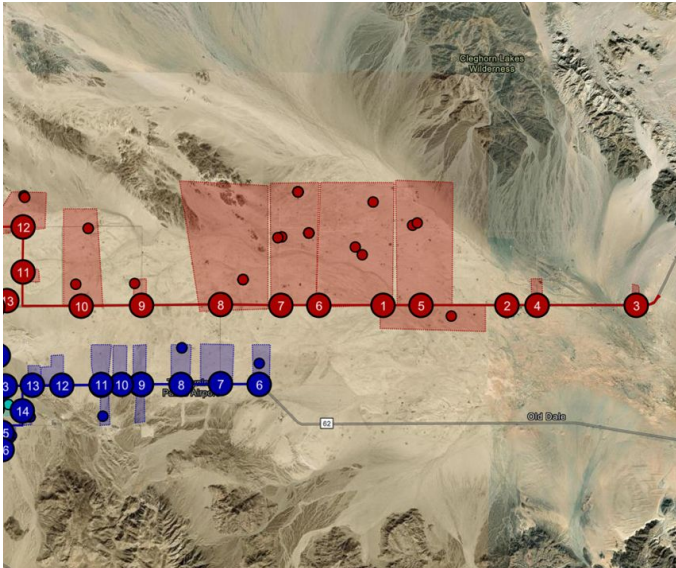
Scenario 2 Boundary Map with 2027 Projections



Scenario 2 Enrollment Projections

	Net	Net CR	2025/26	2027/28	2031/32
	Classrooms	Capacity	Current Enrollment	Projected Enrollment	Projected Enrollment
<u>Elementary Schools</u>					
Condor Elem	30	743	350	372	311
Friendly Hills Elem	23	592	281	375	332
Joshua Tree Elem	20	548	252	346	306
Landers Elem	12	316	120	97	77
Morongo Valley Elem	15	406	184	148	109
Oasis Elem	29	734	423	485	423
Onaga Elem	30	784	586	472	415
Palm Vista Elem	26	696	341		
Twentynine Palms Elem	33	840	503	607	555
Yucca Mesa Elem	27	706	378	336	298
Yucca Valley Elem	34	878	545	494	454
Sub-Totals	279	7,243	3,963	3,732	3,280
<u>Middle/Junior High Schools</u>					
La Contenta Middle	39	1,287	653	591	542
Twentynine Palms Junior High	21	669	648	691	599
Sub-Totals	60	1,956	1,301	1,282	1,141

Scenario 2 Transportation Projections



Current Routes: 10

- TPES 4 Routes
- OES 3 Routes
- PVES 3 Routes

Current Max Run Time: 60 minutes

PVES consolidates to TPES and OES

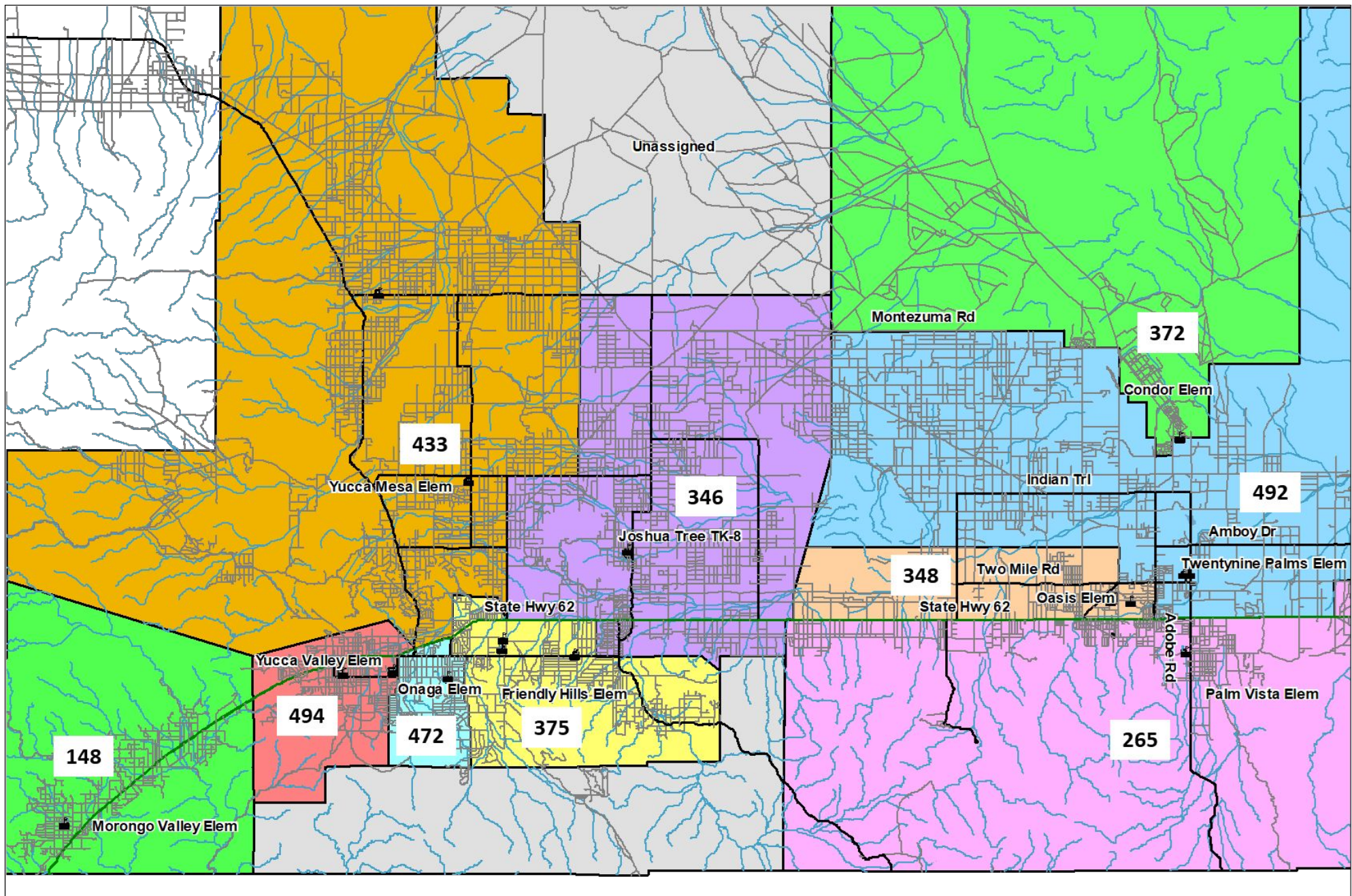
- Increase to 11 Routes (+1)
- Projected Max Run Time: 50 minutes

Boundary Scenario 3 Summary

- Landers closed and boundary area assigned to Yucca Mesa
- Joshua Tree expands to grades TK-8
- West side schools boundaries adjusted for improved balancing
- East side schools boundaries adjusted for improved balancing



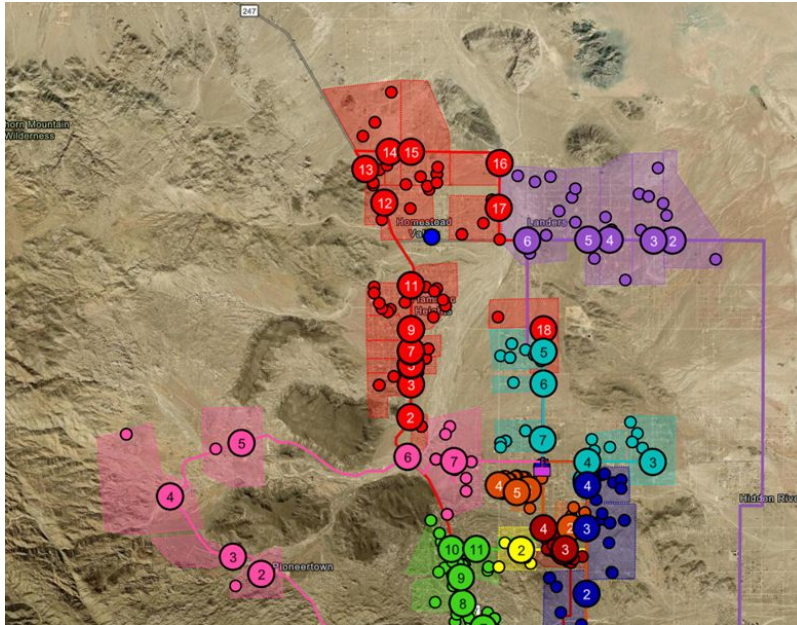
Scenario 3 Boundary Map with 2027 Projections



Scenario 3 Enrollment Projections

			2025/26	2027/28	2031/32
	Net	Net CR	Current	Projected	Projected
<u>Elementary Schools</u>	<u>Classrooms</u>	<u>Capacity</u>	<u>Enrollment</u>	<u>Enrollment</u>	<u>Enrollment</u>
Condor Elem	30	743	350	372	311
Friendly Hills Elem	23	592	281	375	332
Joshua Tree Elem	20	548	252	346	306
Landers Elem	12	316	120		
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Palm Vista Elem	26	658	341	265	233
Twentynine Palms Elem	33	847	503	492	448
Yucca Mesa Elem	27	706	378	433	375
Yucca Valley Elem	34	878	545	494	454
Sub-Totals	279	7,211	3,963	3,745	3,293
 <u>Middle/Junior High Schools</u>					
La Contenta Middle	39	1,287	653	591	542
Twentynine Palms Junior High	21	669	648	691	599
Sub-Totals	60	1,956	1,301	1,282	1,141

Scenario 3 Transportation Projections



Current Routes: 6

- YMES 5 Routes
- LES 1 Route

Current Max Run Time: 72 minutes

LES consolidates to YMES

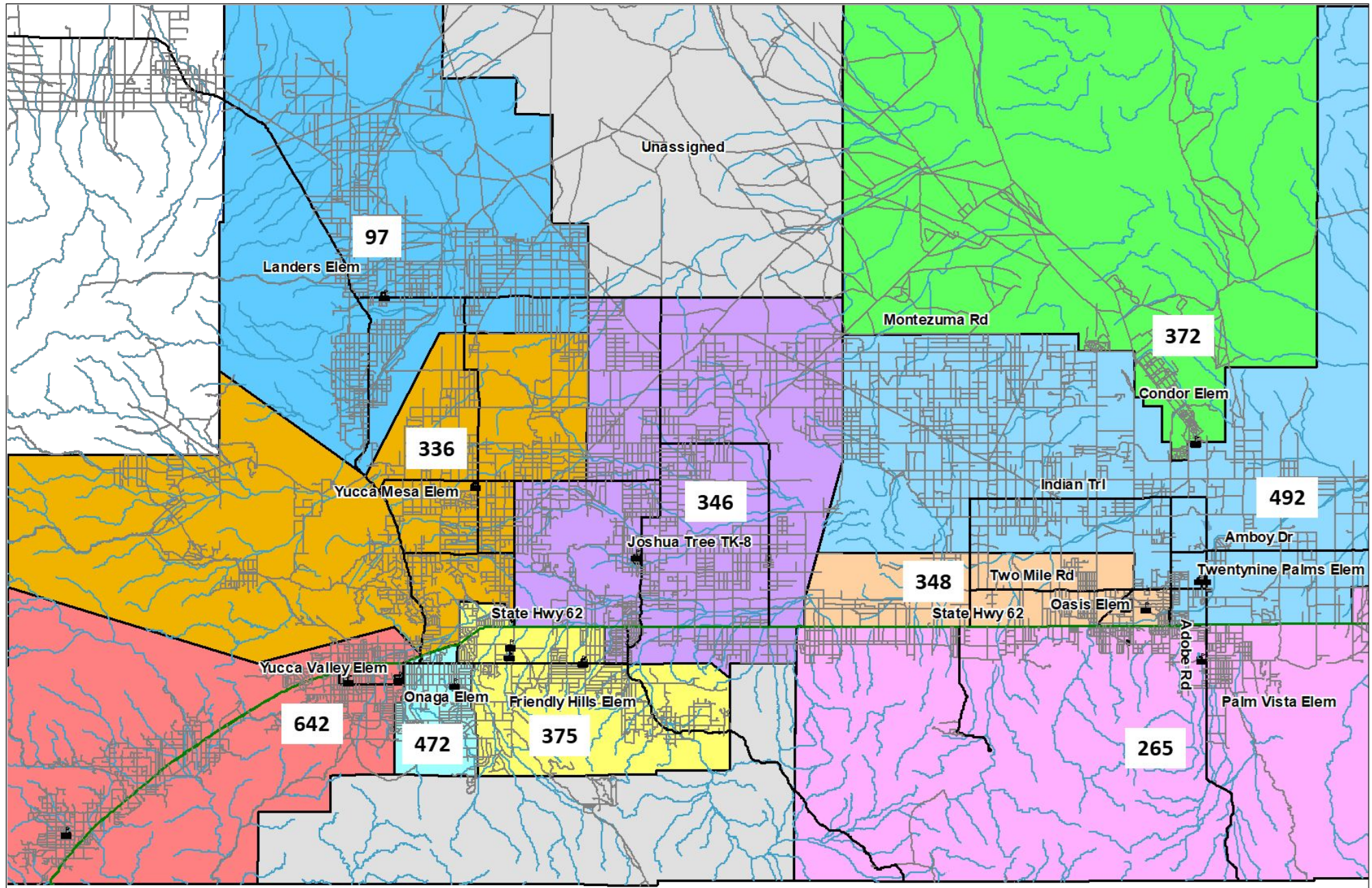
- Increase to 9 Routes (+3)
- Projected Max Run Time: 57 minutes

Boundary Scenario 4 Summary

- Morongo Valley closed and boundary area assigned to Yucca Valley
- Joshua Tree expands to grades TK-8
- West side schools boundaries adjusted for improved balancing
- East side schools boundaries adjusted for improved balancing



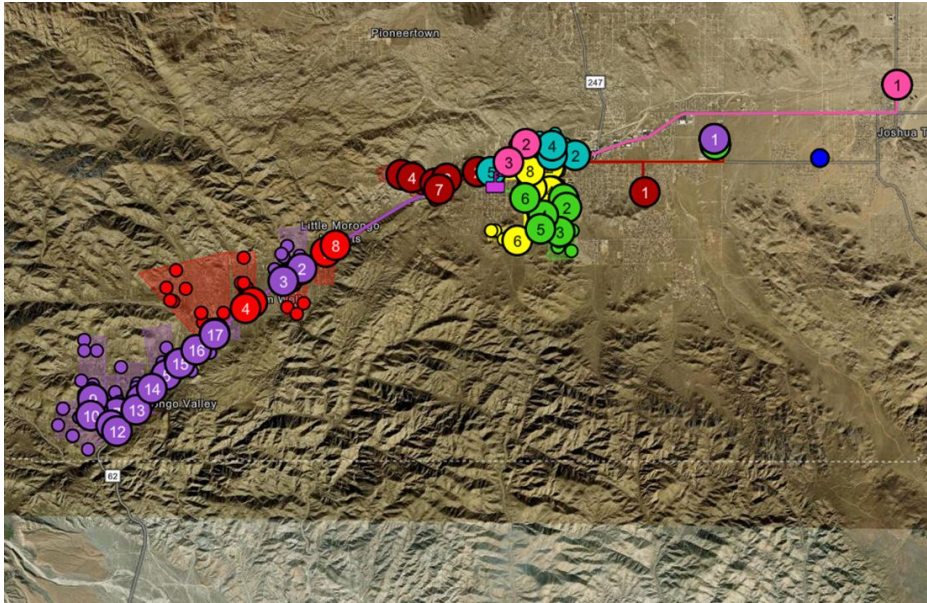
Scenario 4 Boundary Map with 2027 Projections



Scenario 4 Enrollment Projections

	Net	Net CR	2025/26	2027/28	2031/32
	Classrooms	Capacity	Current Enrollment	Projected Enrollment	Projected Enrollment
<u>Elementary Schools</u>					
Condor Elem	30	743	350	372	311
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Scenario 4 Transportation Projections



Current Routes: 5

- YVES 4 Routes
- MVES 1 Route

Current Max Run Time: 67 minutes

MVES consolidates to YVES

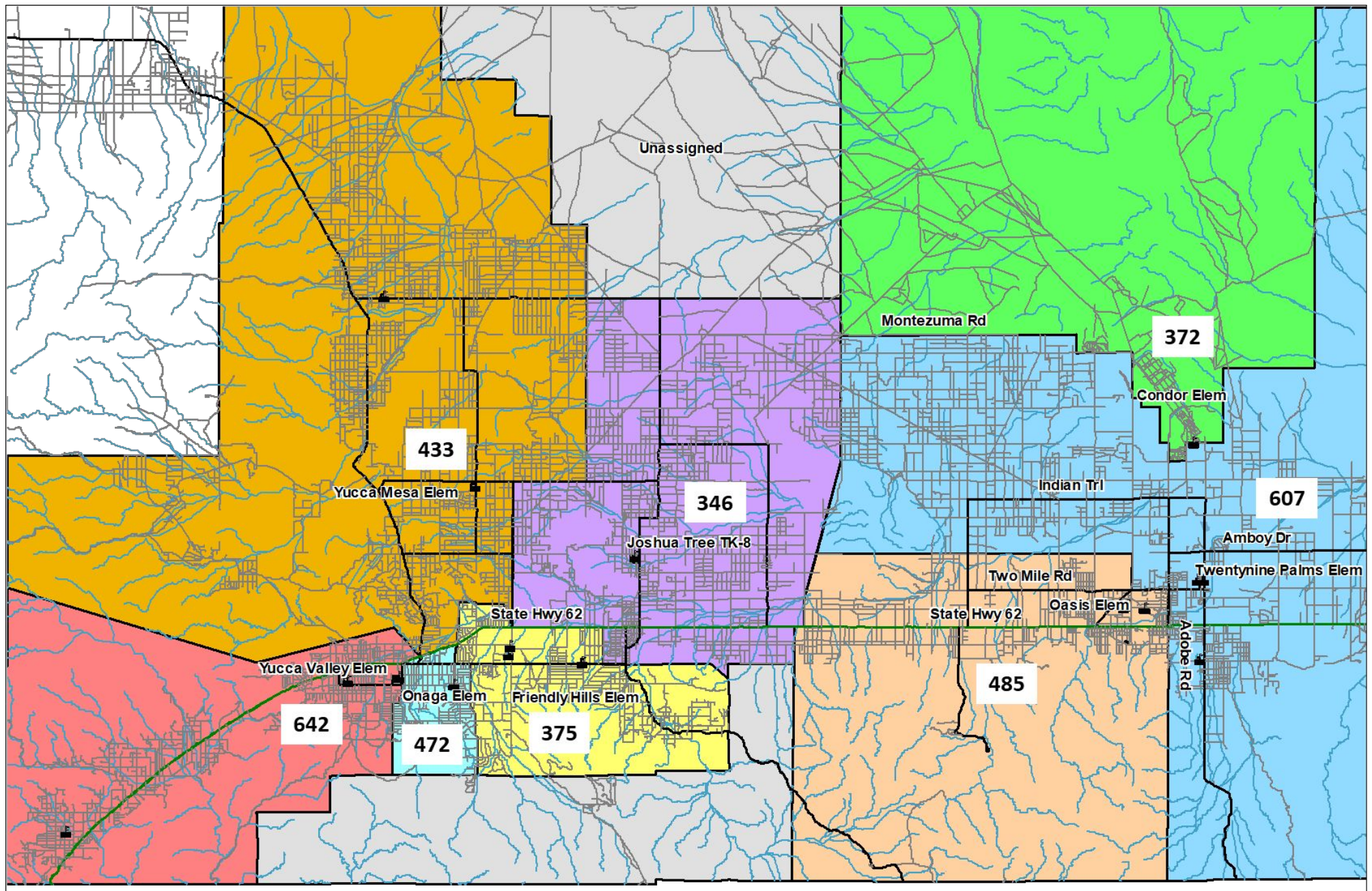
- Increase to 7 Routes (+2)
- Projected Max Run Time: 56 minutes

Boundary Scenario 5 Summary

- Palm Vista closed and boundary area assigned to Oasis/29 Palms
- Landers closed and boundary area assigned to Yucca Mesa
- Morongo Valley closed and boundary area assigned to Yucca Valley
- Joshua Tree expands to grades TK-8
- West side schools boundaries adjusted for improved balancing
- East side schools boundaries adjusted for improved balancing



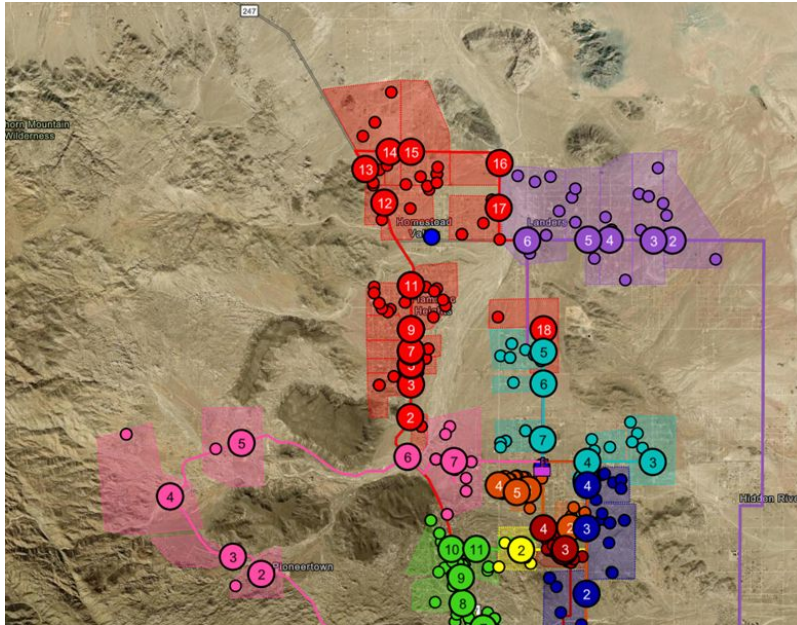
Scenario 5 Boundary Map with 2027 Projections



Scenario 5 Enrollment Projections

			2025/26	2027/28	2031/32
	Net	Net CR	Current	Projected	Projected
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Scenario 5 Transportation Projections



Projected to increase by 8 Routes
across the District

Optimal School Size and Structure

- Between 400 - 450
 - Optimal Resource Allocation
 - Favorable Class Sizes (Less Combos)
 - Transportation Efficiency
- Less Than 200
 - Budget Deficits
 - Loss of Shared Specialist
 - More Combo Classes
- Specific High Desert Challenges
 - Utility Overhead Due to Harsh Climate
 - Inflexible Transportation Costs
 - Consolidation Complexities

Personnel Savings by Tiers

Tier 1	Tier 2	Tier 3
Principal	Principal	Principal
Office Staffing	Office Staffing	Office Staffing
Library	Library	Library
	Custodial	Custodial
	ELOP	ELOP
	Noon Supervision	Noon Supervision
		Nutritional Services
		Mental Health
		MTSS Teachers
		Intervention Teachers

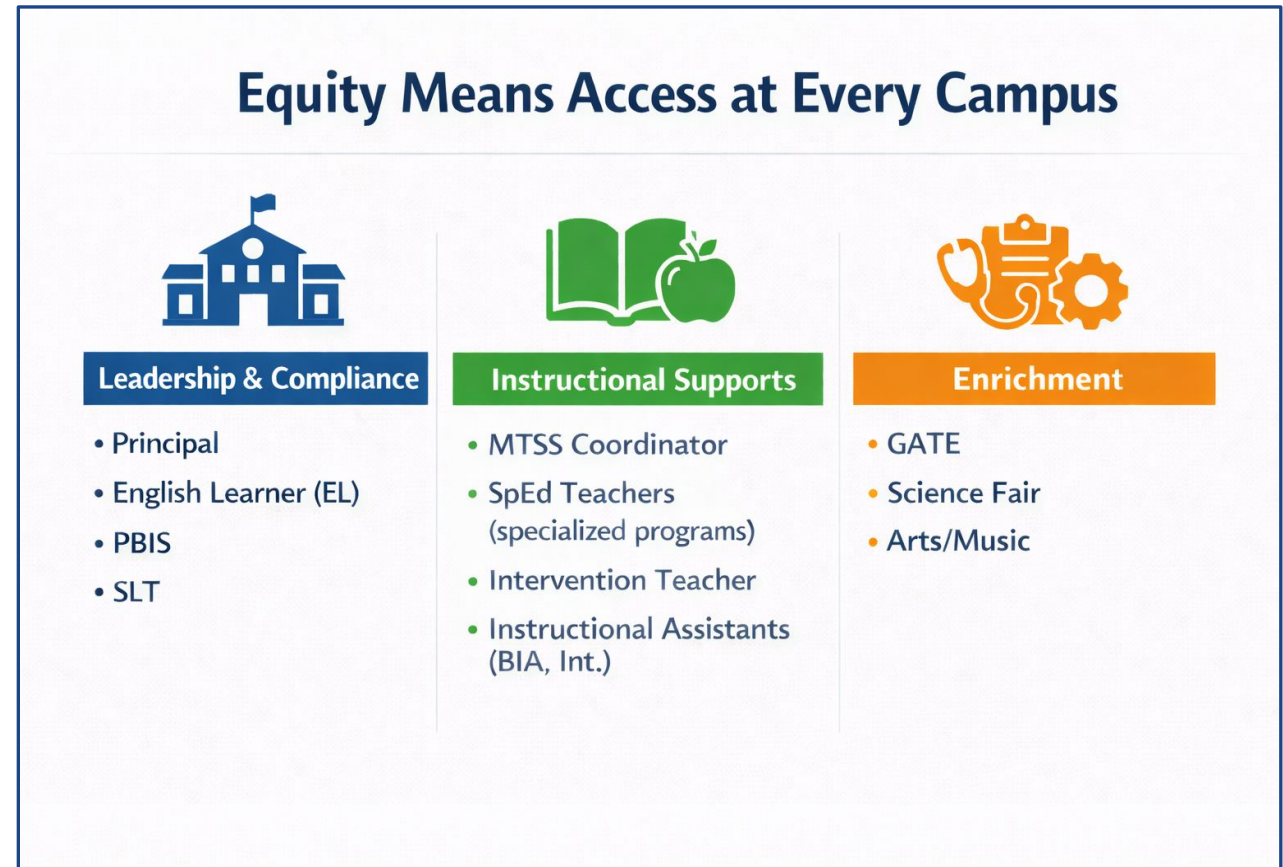


SHIFTING FROM FUNDING TO PROGRAMMING

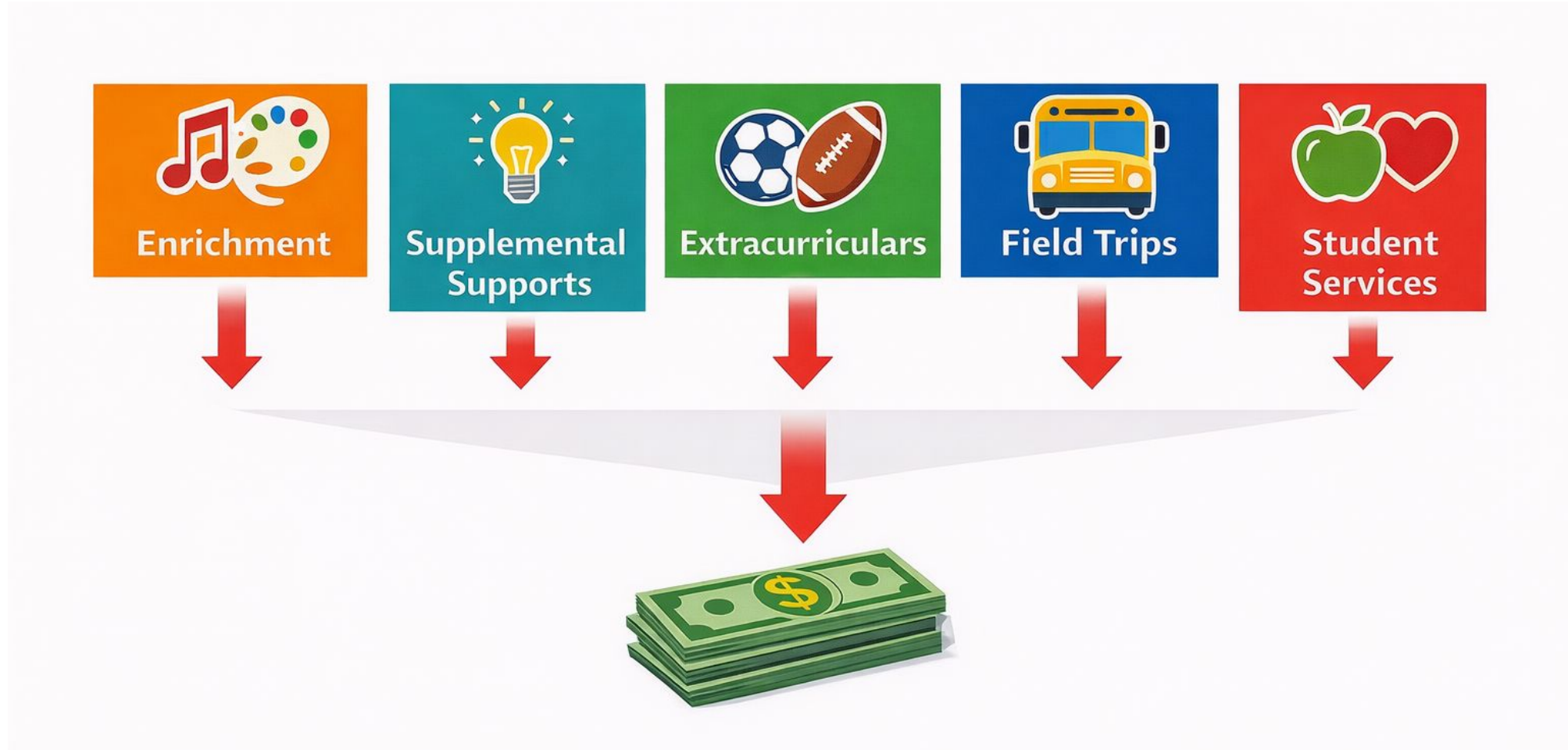


PROGRAMMING STAFF

- Principal
- MTSS Coordinator
- SpEd Teachers (specialized programs)
- Intervention Staff
- Stipend Positions - Coordinators:
 - GATE
 - Science Fair
 - English Learner (EL)
 - PBIS
 - Testing
 - Ed Tech
- SLT Stipends
- Music and Fine Arts

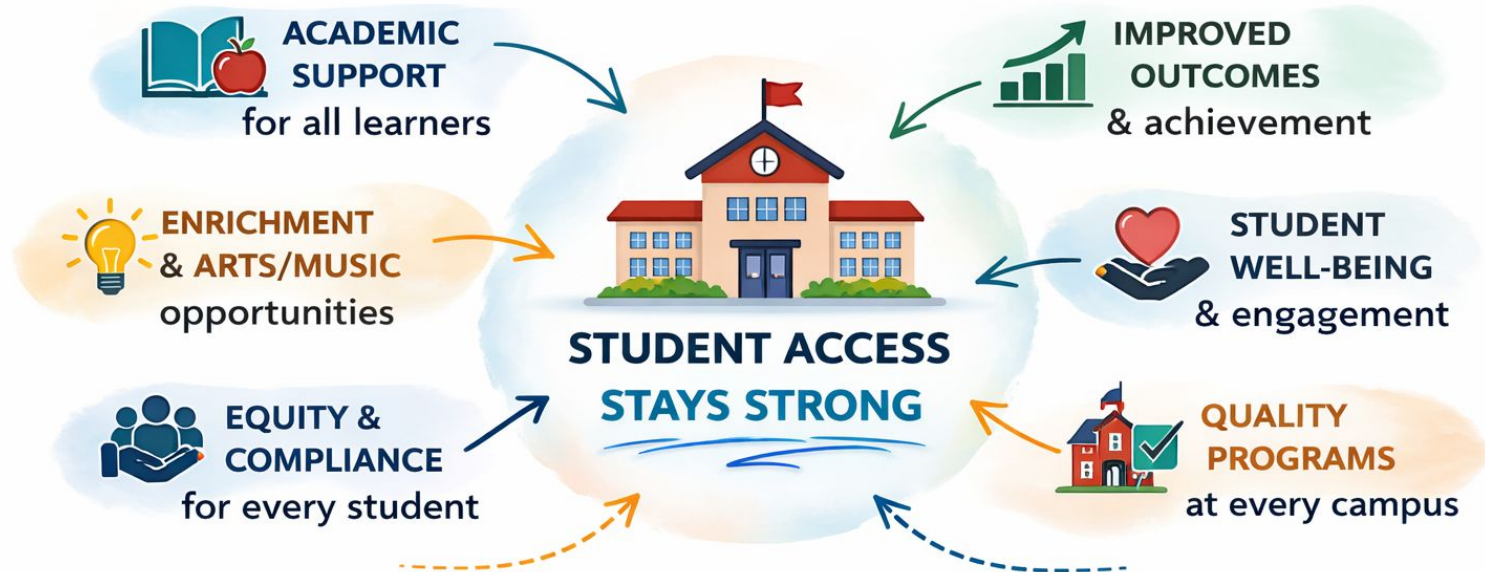


LIMITED RESOURCES - LIMITED PROGRAMS



ENHANCING PROGRAMMING

Students Keep Access to Quality Programs — at Every Campus



OUR VISION — THRIVING, FUTURE-READY SCHOOLS



- Creation of K–8 academies with specialized instruction
- Expanded pathways in Arts, STEM, Language Immersion
- Magnet schools
- Districtwide Visual & Performing Arts Center



Enrollment Committee Recommendations

1. Adjusting school boundaries across the District to better balance elementary school enrollment
2. Refrain from closing any schools and instead prioritize the implementation of alternative cost-saving and enrollment recovery strategies
 - a. Conducting targeted outreach to families residing within MUSD boundaries and returning students to the district.
 - b. Strengthening the district's Multi-Tiered System of Supports
 - c. Expanding and strategically investing in the district's existing Independent Study Program, ACCE, to establish it as a flagship educational offering within MUSD
3. Formalizing advocacy for changes to school funding mechanisms at the state level, including revisions to Average Daily Attendance (ADA) funding and expanded eligibility for rural school funding.



MORONGO
UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT
Our Students. Our Community. Our Future.